

CEO

Isadora Quinn, Macro Oracle

CEO · EXECUTIVE



HIRE
◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Financials funding source.

Whenever a Rates, Market, or Inflation Stress Test resolves, gain 2 Surplus.

At the start of your turn, look at the top card of your deck. You may put it on the bottom.

Called the last three crises and eleven that never came, and bills for all fourteen.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 219 / 374

OFFICE LOCATION

Chicago

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN
◆ 4 branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 3 Equity Futures, Commodity Futures, or Interest-Rate Futures treaties you control, combined (round down).

The weather is volatile, so the book is hedged.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 356 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN
● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 374

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FINANCIALS



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FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

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F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

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Investor Capital

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

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Leverage a turn

MARGIN

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run start

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FINANCIALS

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Leverage a turn

MARGIN

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FINANCIALS

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Leverage a turn

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ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 374

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Investor Capital

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

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Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 374

Private Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½ each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

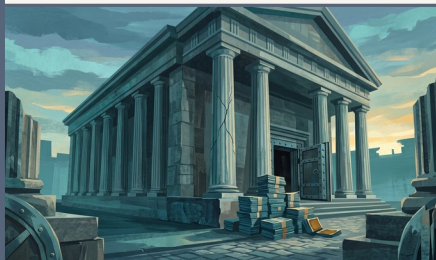
F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 374

Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Inflation ▼ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

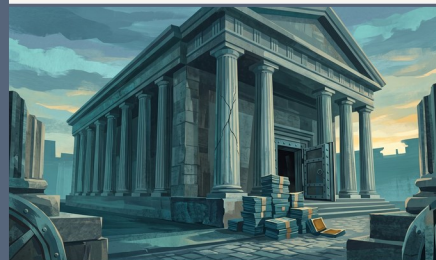
Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 051 / 374

Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Inflation ▼ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 051 / 374

Sports-Gambling Prediction Markets

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Whenever a Regulation, Market, or Geopolitical Stress Test resolves, gain 1 Surplus.

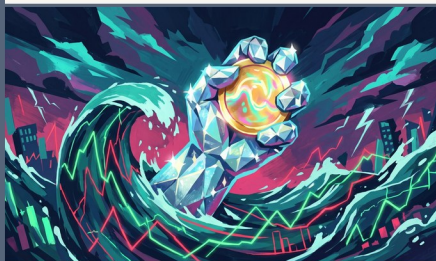
Even the local pub needs to hedge sometimes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 074 / 374

Crypto

STAPLE INVESTMENT



COST

◆ N + 1

SALE

N any time

STAPLE

▲ Low Interest Rates ▲ Short-Term Rates ▼ Long-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

N is the total number of Crypto cards on all companies' boards, including NFT copies. Count before buying or selling.

HODLI (This is not financial advice.)

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 055 / 374

Short Sale

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Play only against a Market Stress Test. Gain 3 Surplus.

Schadenfreude: German for enjoying someone else's portfolio falling.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 125 / 374

Short Sale

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Play only against a Market Stress Test. Gain 3 Surplus.

Schadenfreude: German for enjoying someone else's portfolio falling.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 125 / 374

Market Data Terminal

DATA



PRICE

◆ 3

Your Market and Liquidity Surprise Inspections cost 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

Thirty thousand dollars a year for a keyboard with colored keys, and the one chat room the whole market is in.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 361 / 374

Former Regulator

EXECUTIVE

DARK



HIRE

◆ 3

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to stop a Regulation Stress Test that hits you.

Wrote the rule and now bills by the hour to explain it.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 216 / 374

INVESTMENT

Trading Desk

INVESTMENT



COST ♦ 3	YIELD ● 2 each turn	SALE 2 any time
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▲ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if a Market Stress Test hits you.

Buys low, sells high, and has a very good explanation for the other days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 080 / 374

TALENT

Pod PM

FRONT LINE



HIRE
♦ 2

Requires a Financials funding source.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 5 of your loss from its Short-Term Equity or Long-Term Equity clauses. Then fire this employee.

Hits the drawdown limit, clears the desk by noon, has three offers by dinner.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 228 / 374

TALENT

Pod PM

FRONT LINE



HIRE
♦ 2

Requires a Financials funding source.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 5 of your loss from its Short-Term Equity or Long-Term Equity clauses. Then fire this employee.

Hits the drawdown limit, clears the desk by noon, has three offers by dinner.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 228 / 374

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

Short Volatility Note

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT



COST ♦ 3	YIELD ● 2 each turn	SALE 2 any time
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SIGNATURE

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Destroyed if a Market Stress Test hits you.

Nine years of smooth returns, collected one small premium at a time, until one Tuesday afternoon took them all back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 082 / 374

INVESTMENT

Contingent Convertibles

INVESTMENT



COST ♦ 3	YIELD ● 2 each turn	SALE 2 any time
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Destroyed if a Regulation Stress Test hits you.

The buyer read 'bond' where the regulator read 'equity,' and the prospectus had said so all along.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 083 / 374

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

Discount Tail Hedge

TREATY



COST ♦ 1		
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SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

When a Market Stress Test would cost you more than 4 Surplus, prevent the rest.

Destroyed if Great Recession, Great Depression, or Flash Crash hits you.

Sold by a fund that has never missed a payment, having never been asked for one.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 154 / 374

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

Iced Tea Blockchain Co.

SIGNATURE INVESTMENT

DARK



COST ♦ 1	SALE 3 any time	
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DARK SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Signature: one copy per deck.

Destroyed if Short-Seller Report or Short and Distort hits you.

The same beverages under a new name, with a new press release and a new share price.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 084 / 374

OFFICE LOCATION

New York

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN
♦ 4 branch only

▲ Litigation

Headquarters or **Open** as a branch.

The first Investment you play on your turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

The deal closes before the lunch reservation does.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 350 / 374

INVESTMENT

VIX Calls

INVESTMENT



COST ♦ 2	SALE 1 any time	CARRYING COST ● 1 each turn
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When a Stress Test with a Volatility clause hits you, gain 10% of the Surplus the whole table loses after protection and recoveries. Add your long-vol payouts, then round down.

Calm markets cost you a little every month, until everyone else's bad day pays you back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 095 / 374

INVESTMENT

VIX Calls

INVESTMENT

COST

◆ 2

SALE

1 any time

CARRYING COST

◆ 1 each turn

When a Stress Test with a Volatility clause hits you, gain 10% of the Surplus the whole table loses after protection and recovers. Add your long-vol payouts, then round down.

Calm markets cost you a little every month, until everyone else's bad day pays you back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 095 / 374

RISK MANAGEMENT

Delta Hedging

TREATY

COST

◆ 0

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Short-Term Equity exposures counts as Volatility instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier Risk Management cards choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

The risk did not leave so much as change desks.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 157 / 374

RISK MANAGEMENT

Delta Hedging

TREATY

COST

◆ 0

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Short-Term Equity exposures counts as Volatility instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier Risk Management cards choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

The risk did not leave so much as change desks.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 157 / 374

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Asset Freeze

GEOPOLITICAL

COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one Investment to discard without Sale proceeds, chosen by the runner.

The position was marked at full value right up until the moment it could not be sold, moved, or mentioned.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 336 / 374

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Margin Call

LIQUIDITY

COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 2 per Volatility exposure, and 2 per investment they control.

The broker would like a word, and also your cash.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 276 / 374

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Margin Call

LIQUIDITY

COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 2 per Volatility exposure, and 2 per investment they control.

The broker would like a word, and also your cash.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 276 / 374

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Quantitative Easing

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 2008

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Low Interest Rates

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Low Interest Rates exposure.

In November 2008, the Federal Reserve began buying hundreds of billions of dollars of bonds to push long-term interest rates down. It was very clear about its plans, which was the problem.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 251 / 374

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Volcker Shock

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1979

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Rates ▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Rates exposure, 2 per Liquidity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

In October 1979 the Federal Reserve let short-term rates climb toward 20% to break inflation, and the savings and loans that had funded 30-year mortgages with passbook savings never recovered.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 302 / 374

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

1973 Oil Crisis

INFLATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 1973

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Inflation ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Short-Term Rates

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Inflation exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 4 per Short-Term Rates exposure.

In October 1973, Arab oil producers cut off exports to the United States and other countries, quadrupling oil prices and setting off years of high inflation.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 262 / 374

Liberation Day Tariffs

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2025



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Inflation ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure, 6 per Inflation exposure, and 3 per Volatility exposure.

On April 2, 2025, the United States announced tariffs on imports from nearly every country; stocks fell more than 10% in two days, and a week later most of the increases were paused.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 261 / 374

Debt Ceiling Breach

MARKET



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Liquidity
▲ Short-Term Rates ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Rates exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Long-Term Treasuries it controls.

Everyone knew the date, which Congress treated as a suggestion.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 268 / 374

Flash Crash

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

On May 6, 2010, a burst of automated selling briefly wiped about a trillion dollars off the value of U.S. stocks. The Dow fell almost 1,000 points in minutes, then mostly came back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 284 / 374

Spitzer Broker Probe

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2004



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Dark card in its discard pile.

In October 2004, New York's attorney general sued the largest insurance broker for steering clients and rigging bids, in a probe that reached the whole industry.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 301 / 374

AI Bubble Bursts

MARKET



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every AI card and every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

It was three laptops in a trench coat the whole time.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 265 / 374

Northern Rock Bank Run

LIQUIDITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2007



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure. Then each company discards half its Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Junk Bonds, Private Credit Fund, or Feeder Fund it controls.

In September 2007, Northern Rock sought emergency support as wholesale funding dried up. Depositors queued outside its branches.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 269 / 374

Bird Flu Pandemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

Talk about a viral tweet!

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 242 / 374

Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 287 / 374

2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 234 / 374

AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.

On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 285 / 374

Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.

On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 340 / 374

Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.

In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 257 / 374

Klarna's Down Round

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.

In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 306 / 374